Akosua Kernizan

akosuakernizan@gmail.com | LinkedIn: /in/akosuak/ | akosuak.com

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Strong: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Lit Elements, Web Components, GraphQL (queries, mutations), OOP, Express, Webpack, Git/GitHub, CSS/SCSS, HTML, jQuery, OAuth 2.0, Authentication, RESTful architecture, JIRA, Confluence, Agile/Scrum, Tailwind
Experienced: Redux, Node TDD (Jest, Cypress, Enzyme), PHP, SQL/NoSQL, YAML, Python

EXPERIENCE

Reddit | Software Engineer, New York, NY **May 2021 - Feb 2026**

- Led design and rollout of an LLM-based detection system to identify NCIM-risk subreddits, expanding user warning eligibility beyond manually-banned communities and reaching 10,400+ users with a 79% verified accuracy rate (7% false positive rate)
- Implemented NetzDG compliance logic for German content regulations, saving the company a €100K fine
- Designed and built the frontend for user-blocking functionality end-to-end, delivering a seamless, intuitive user experience
- Selected for a tiger team to migrate Reddit's platform from React to Lit Elements/Web Components; authored frontend GraphQL documentation and updated the internal templating system to support the transition
- Built key frontend components of the report flow, improving the clarity and usability of the reporting experience for users
- Mentored an intern through career development and technical guidance, contributing to their successful conversion to a full-time role
- Led the WmEng Employee Resource Group, organizing initiatives to advance diversity, inclusion, and professional development across the engineering org

Buffy | Fullstack Engineer, New York, NY **Nov 2019 - Feb 2020**

- Migrated legacy codebase to a headless architecture using GatsbyJS and Contentful, improving performance and aligning with modern web standards
- Built a Cypress test suite documenting core functionality, improving debuggability and cross-browser reliability
- Maintained legacy Shopify storefront (Liquid, jQuery) to preserve site stability during the migration
- Partnered with Product and Design to translate Abstract/Sketch wireframes into production UI

Wunderkind | Software Engineer, New York, NY **Nov 2016 - Nov 2019**

- Built GDPR-compliant custom client campaign integrations using JavaScript, jQuery, and PHP
- Streamlined the email service provider (ESP) integration process by authoring and distributing custom documentation
- Led intra-departmental presentations on debugging ESP campaigns/APIs, improving turnaround time and cross-team communication
- Provided onboarding training and technical mentorship to engineers via code review and pair programming
- Applied TDD practices to build new client-facing features without breaking existing integrations

Sesame Workshop | Frontend Developer, New York, NY **Aug 2015 - Oct 2016**

- Built the "Special Projects Department" portfolio site using jQuery, UI Bootstrap, and AngularJS, adopting an MVC architecture to streamline future updates
- Created custom HTML/CSS/JavaScript English-learning games for pre-K children in China and Japan using a custom CMS
- Collaborated directly with project managers, animators, and writers to navigate code constraints and meet deadlines

OUTREACH

Colorstack Conference | Virtual Speaker Mentor/Mentee Relationships **2023**
Rewriting the Code's InclYOUsion Day | Recruiting Event **2024**

EDUCATION

University of Kansas | Biology **2011**